The family of two of the deceased Taj employees shared their experiences of meeting with Ratan. Sunu Varghese recalled that at the beginning of December, just about a week after the tragedy, she received a call from the Taj's HR department. The caller said, 'Mr Ratan Tata would like to meet you' on 4 December at the Taj President.

It was not even a week since Sunu had buried her husband Thomas, who was the sole breadwinner of the family. She was distraught as her two sons and Varghese's eighty-year-old mother had suddenly become her responsibility. Sunu went for the meeting with Ratan with her two sons: Wesley, who was doing his BSc in nursing, and Rynell, who was in class nine. At 11 p.m., she received a message to meet the relief team. She did not expect the meeting to last for more than a couple of minutes, as the team had already spent the whole day talking with the other families.

She and her family were ushered in front of the team that consisted of Ratan, Krishna Kumar and Bickson. The presence of the seniormost functionaries of the Taj and the group chairman, whom she had only heard her husband speak in awe of, overwhelmed the already dazed widow.

She just cried as Ratan struggled to persuade her that hope still existed and her family could maintain their standard of living and she could stand on her own feet. Sunu had been planning to shift residence to her home state of Kerala. Explaining this to the team, she said, 'I have lost everything, and we will go home now.'

Ratan instantly replied, 'From today, you are a part of the Taj family and till you die, Taj will take care of you,' Sunu recalls. He continued, 'We lost one of our golden staff [members].'

On hearing this, Sunu gathered courage, looked up and said, 'No sir, if you say that you have lost a golden staff [member], I have lost my husband, but I'm proud of him that he laid down his life for a great company.' On hearing this, the chairman's eyes filled with tears.

As I interviewed her, Sunu abruptly stopped narrating her experience to me and hurriedly excused herself, hiding her face with her hands, unable to contain the sudden rush of emotions. Before she left, she told me, 'I have not seen God. But that day I saw God in him. God was in front of me.'

During the meeting, Ratan and Krishna Kumar also asked Sunu what her children were doing, what they would like to do in life and how the company could help take care of her family. Turning to Rynell, Kumar asked what he wanted to be when he grew up. Rynell said that he wanted to